

UNIT 7 / Home and neighbourhood

Where are my keys?

Your goal: Use common location phrases with in, auf and neben.

01 Learn the idea

Ask Wo? for a fixed location. In common location phrases, masculine der and neuter das become dem, and feminine die becomes der: auf dem Tisch, in der Tasche. These are dative forms. Learn the phrases as chunks before trying to change every noun independently.

In means in, auf on a surface and neben next to. Das Buch ist auf dem Tisch locates the book. This lesson describes where things are, not where you move them; movement towards a destination can require a different case. Practise with objects already resting in place.

Words and phrases

German	English
auf dem Tisch	on the table
in der Tasche	in the bag
neben dem Bett	next to the bed
Wo ist mein Handy?	Where is my mobile phone?
Hier ist der Schlüssel.	Here is the key.

Say each phrase aloud. Listen on the lesson page, then repeat without looking at the English.

02 Conversation and mission

Read the conversation once for meaning. Repeat both roles, then cover the English and perform it again.

Ben

Wo ist mein Handy?

Where is my mobile phone?

Mia

Es ist auf dem Tisch.

It is on the table.

Ben

Und der Schlüssel?

And the key?

Mia

Der ist in der Tasche.

It is in the bag.

Your real-life mission

Place a book on a table and a key in a bag. Describe their locations. Draw a bed with an object next to it and label the scene.

Plan or write your response here. Try first; a model appears in the answer key.

03 Practice without peeking

Choose one answer per question. For the final question, return to the conversation. Mark difficult items and explain your choice before checking the key.

1. What does “auf dem Tisch” mean?

- A. in the bag
- B. next to the bed
- C. on the table

2. What does “in der Tasche” mean?

- A. in the bag
- B. next to the bed
- C. Where is my mobile phone?

3. What does “neben dem Bett” mean?

- A. Where is my mobile phone?
- B. next to the bed
- C. Here is the key.

4. Complete the fixed location: auf ____ Tisch.

- A. den
- B. dem
- C. das

5. Where is the key?

- A. On the table
- B. Next to the bed
- C. In the bag

Reflection: Which phrase will you use this week?

04 Answer key and review

1. C - on the table

“auf dem Tisch” means “on the table”. Read the example aloud, then use it in your own sentence.

2. A - in the bag

“in der Tasche” means “in the bag”. Read the example aloud, then use it in your own sentence.

3. B - next to the bed

“neben dem Bett” means “next to the bed”. Read the example aloud, then use it in your own sentence.

4. B - dem

For a fixed location with auf, masculine Tisch uses the dative dem.

5. C - In the bag

Mia locates it in der Tasche.

One possible mission response

Das Buch ist auf dem Tisch. Der Schlüssel ist in der Tasche. Die Lampe ist neben dem Bett.

Your own answer can differ. Check whether it completes the task and uses the lesson's patterns.

Build the habit

Today: say five phrases aloud. Tomorrow: cover the answers and try the quiz again. In one week: repeat the conversation with your own details.

Continue learning

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